

Document Design and Graphics

A cluttered room makes it hard for people to find what they are looking for. Similarly, a cluttered document with poor design confuses readers and discourages them. If readers cannot find information quickly, they lose interest. Good technical writers design pages that are visually clear and comfortable to read.

Designing the Document

Document design means choosing how to present elements (text, headings, spacing, graphics, etc.) so the message becomes clear and effective. A well-designed document helps the reader understand the information faster and creates a positive impression of the topic. Writers use design elements to keep the reader's attention. These elements directly affect the layout of the page. The main document design elements are:

1. White Space

White space is the empty or blank area on a page. It helps the eyes rest, separates information, and makes a document look clean and inviting.

Examples of white space:

- The margins on the sides of the page
- Space between paragraphs
- Space around images or tables
- Empty lines used to separate sections

Example:

If a page is full of long paragraphs without breaks, the reader feels overwhelmed. Adding space between paragraphs makes the page easier to read.

2. Text

Text refers to the words printed on the page or screen. Readers understand text more easily when it is **left-justified** (straight left edge, uneven right edge). Writers also use highlighting features to draw attention:

- **Bold** → to emphasize important terms
- *Italics* → for titles or foreign words
- Underline → for specific emphasis
- CAPITAL LETTERS → for warnings

Example:

Instead of writing:

"Important safety instructions must be followed"

Write:

"Important: Follow all safety instructions."

3. Headings

Headings are short titles that introduce the main idea of a section. They help the reader see the structure of a document instantly. Headings act like signboards on a highway—they guide the reader.

Example:

Instead of writing one long chapter about "Computer Networks," break it as:

- **Introduction**
- **Types of Networks**
- **Network Devices**
- **Security Issues**

This makes the document easier to navigate.

4. Graphics

Graphics are visual representations of information.

They include:

- Tables
- Line graphs
- Pie charts
- Bar graphs
- Diagrams
- Flowcharts

Graphics are used when information can be understood better visually than through words.

Example:

Instead of writing:

“Sales increased from 10,000 to 15,000 in 2024,”

a simple **bar graph** communicates this faster.

Writers often combine text + graphics for full clarity.



5. Medium

The medium is the form in which the document appears.

It can be:

- Printed on paper
- Displayed on a screen (web, PDF, mobile app)

The purpose and audience decide which medium is best.

Example:

A technical manual for mechanics might be printed (since phones may not be allowed in the workshop),

but software documentation is usually digital.

The medium also influences how much white space, headings, and graphics can be used.

Who Reads Graphics?

To design effective graphics, we must understand:

A. Audience

Technical fields like engineering, medicine, and marketing rely heavily on visual data.

However, different readers have different abilities to understand graphics.

Generally, **the more data a graphic contains, the harder it becomes to read.**

To choose the right graphic, we ask:

- How much does my reader already know?
- How interested is the reader in the subject?
- Is the audience technical or non-technical?
- Will technical diagrams confuse them?
- Is their reading level high or low?

Example:

For the general public → simple bar chart

For engineers → detailed line graph with labelled axes

B. Purpose and Objectives

Audience is one factor, but we must also know **what** the graphic should achieve.

Ask:

- What is the purpose of the writing?
- How can a graphic help achieve that purpose?

After answering these, choose the graphic that conveys the message most effectively.

Example:

If the purpose is to compare percentages → use a **pie chart**

If the purpose is to show change over time → use a **line graph**

Designing Graphics

Effective graphics improve understanding.

To design good graphics, we must keep them simple and neat, integrate them with text, help readers interpret them quickly, give credit for borrowed graphics, and use color wisely.

1. Keep Graphics Neat and Simple

A clean graphic is easier to read and interpret.

Good graphics have enough white space, clear labels, and appropriate sizing.

Key points:

- Leave enough space so the graphic does not look crowded.
- Make graphics large enough to be readable.
- Use numbers, decimals, and percentage symbols correctly.
- Label all important parts clearly.

Example:

A bar graph showing exam results should clearly label:

- X-axis → Subjects
 - Y-axis → Marks
 - Each bar → Student's performance
- Without these labels, the reader becomes confused.

2. Integrate Graphics with Text

Graphics must appear **with their explanation** on the same page.

This prevents readers from flipping pages to understand a figure.

Rules:

- Use the word **Table** for a formal table.
- Use **Figure** for charts, diagrams, or other visuals.
- Provide a **title** for every graphic.
 - Table titles → usually above the table

- Figure titles → usually below the graphic
- Keep descriptions short and clear.
- At the end of the explanation, highlight the main trend.

Example:

Figure 1: Monthly Rainfall in Kathmandu (2024)

(Insert line graph)

Below the figure:

“This figure shows that rainfall is highest in July and lowest in December. Overall, Kathmandu receives heavy rainfall during the monsoon months.”

3. Give Credit for Borrowed Graphics

If you use a graphic that you did not create, or you created it using someone else’s data, you must give credit.

How to credit:

- Write **Source:** below the figure.
- Include reference information similar to a footnote or endnote.

Example:

Source: Government of Nepal, Department of Hydrology and Meteorology (2023)

4. Use Color Effectively

Color attracts attention even before text.

It can guide the reader, highlight important points, and make a document appealing.

Color helps to:

- Indicate organization (e.g., different colors for headings)
- Emphasize or clarify key points
- Support meaning (e.g., red for danger, green for safe)
- Make the document visually attractive

How to Use Color Effectively

a. Avoid Overusing Color

Using more than three or four colors can overwhelm the reader.

Using one bright color too often can distract them.

Example:

A pie chart with ten different colors is confusing → limit to 3–4 colors.

b. Apply Color Consistently

If you choose a color system, use it throughout the document.

Example:

- Major headings → red
- Key terms → bold black

Do **not** suddenly change your headings to blue or highlight keywords in green.

c. Be Aware of Cultural Meanings of Colors

Different cultures see colors differently.

Examples:

- Americans → green = go, red = stop/danger
- Muslims → green is a holy color
- South Africans → red represents mourning

Consider the audience before choosing colors.

d. Avoid Unusual Color Combinations

Some color combinations are hard to read.

Bad combinations:

- Purple text on a blue background
- Orange text on a red background

Better combinations:

Dark text on a light background.

Constructing Graphics

Before drawing lines, shapes, text, or images, we must understand how graphics are constructed. Graphics include tables, charts, diagrams, and other visual elements used to present information clearly.

Below are the different types of graphic constructions.

1. Tables

Tables present words and numbers organized into **rows and columns**.

A table is not just a random grouping—it is a **systematic technique** for presenting data so it can be easily read and compared.

Essential Parts of a Table

- **Number:** Every table should be numbered (e.g., Table 1).
- **Title:** Clear and concise description of what the table shows.
- **Stub:** Categories listed along the **Y-axis** (rows).
- **Caption / Column Headings:** Categories listed along the **X-axis** (columns).
- **Body:** The cells that contain the actual data.
- **Source:** Mentioned below the table if data is borrowed.
- **Footnotes:** Additional clarifying information, if needed.

Example: Formal Table

(Formal tables use straight lines and consistent formatting.)

Table 1: Distribution of Respondents by Gender

S.N.	Gender	21–30	31–40	41–50	51–60	Total	Percent
1	Male	6	10	5	2	24	48.98
2	Female	10	6	3	2	21	51.02
Total	—	16	16	8	4	44	100

Source: Field Survey (2020)

Informal tables may have no grid lines and a simpler layout.

2. Graphs / Charts

A graph displays data visually using statistical shapes.

It helps readers see patterns, comparisons, and relationships.

Common types:

a. Bar Graphs

Represent data using rectangular bars whose height/length reflects a value.

Can be **vertical** or **horizontal**.

1. Simple Bar Diagram

Used for **one variable**.

Example:

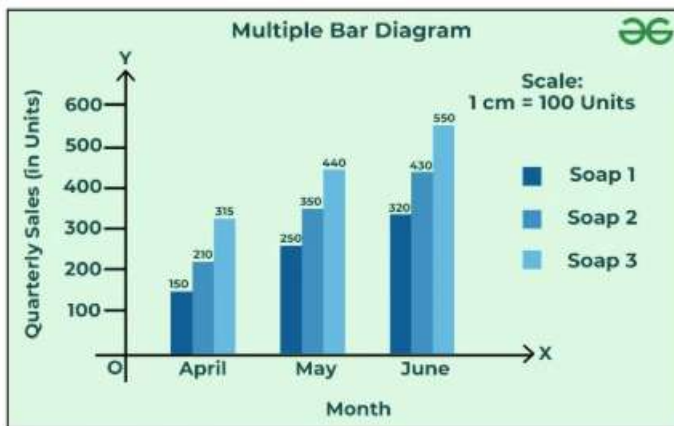


2. Multiple Bar Diagram

Used to compare **two or more sets of statistical data**.

Bars for each category are placed **side-by-side**.

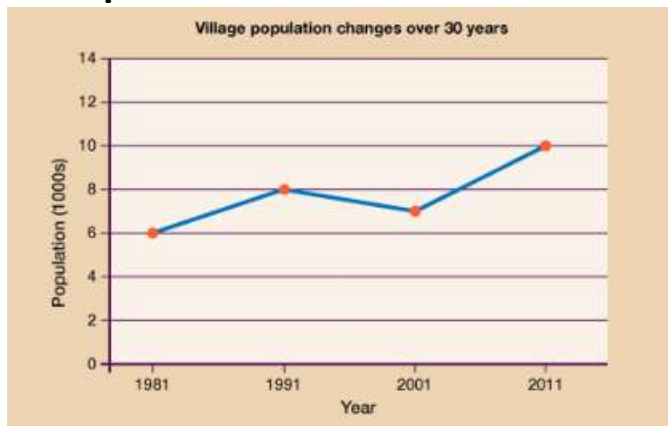
Example:



b. Line Graph

Uses a horizontal (X) and vertical (Y) axis, but instead of bars, it uses a **line** to show trends.

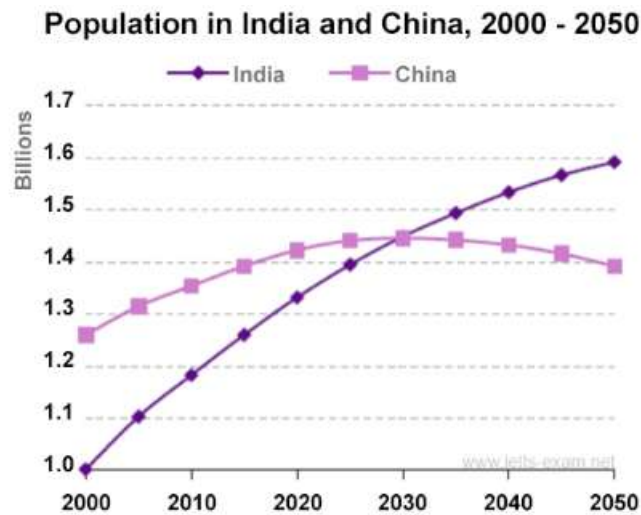
Example:



c. Multiple Line Graph

Uses **more than one line** to compare two or more trends.

Example:



d. Pictograph

Uses **pictures or icons** instead of bars to represent data. It adds color, interest, and is easy for non-native speakers.

Rules:

- Icons must be **simple and recognizable**.
- Icons must be **consistent in size**.

Example:

Mode of transport	Number of students
Bus	8 smiley faces
Car	4 smiley faces
Walking	6 smiley faces
Bycycle	3 smiley faces
Key : 😊 Represents 4 children	

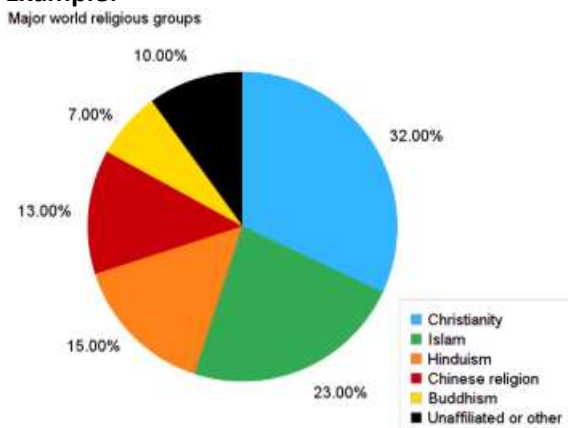
e. Pie Chart

A circular chart showing **parts of a whole**, totaling **100%**.

Slices move **clockwise from the largest to the smallest**.

Should not contain more than **7 sections**.

Example:

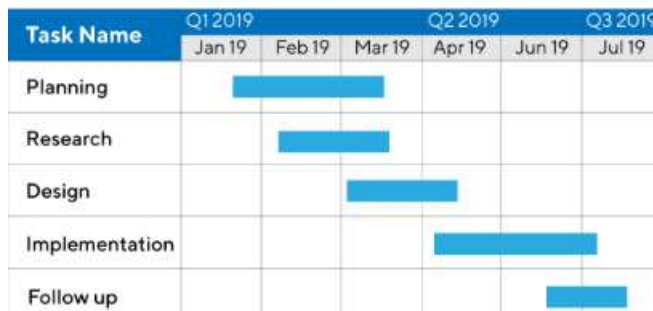


f. Gantt Chart

A bar chart used for **scheduling major tasks** in a project.

Example:

Gantt Chart



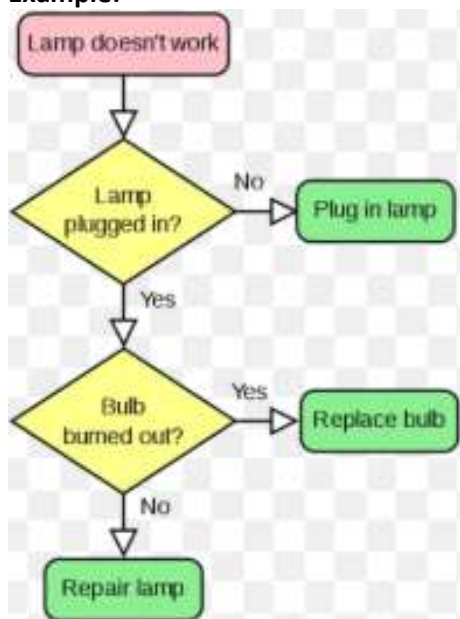
g. Decision Flowchart

Uses symbols to show where a process begins, ends, and where decisions occur.

Common Symbols:

- **Oval:** Start / End
- **Rectangle:** Activity / Process
- **Diamond:** Decision
- **Arrow:** Flow of process

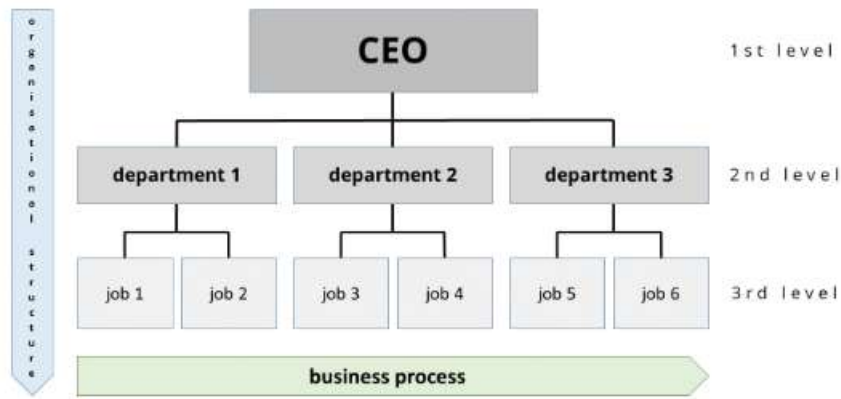
Example:



h. Organizational Chart

Shows the structure of an organization using boxes and connecting lines.

Example:



Writing for the Web

Writing for the web means preparing information that online readers can **find quickly, understand easily, and use immediately**.

Web pages share information through text, images, audio, video, and interactive elements. To publish a webpage, we need basic knowledge of how information appears on the Internet through browsers and simple markup languages like HTML.

Getting Started on Web Pages

Before creating web content or designing pages, you need:

- A text editor such as **Notepad, VS Code, or Sublime**.
- Basic understanding of **HTML, CSS, and JavaScript**.
- A plan for how the finished website should look and function.

Once your files and folders are organized and your code is complete, you must **publish the website online** so users can view it.

Reading Web Pages

People read online pages **differently** from printed text.

Key Differences

- Printed materials are read **linearly** from top to bottom.
- Online readers **scan** the center first, then move left and right.
- They look for **keywords, buttons, headings, and links**.
- They move through text by **clicking links**, not turning pages.
- They expect **speed, clarity, and convenience**.

Example:

A reader on a shopping website scans for the product image, price, reviews, and “Add to Cart” button instead of reading every line.

Planning Web Pages

Before writing text for a website, consider two major questions:

1. What is the purpose?

Example: To inform, advertise, educate, entertain, or sell.

2. Who is the audience?

Example: Students, customers, travelers, patients, or children.

Your challenge is to **meet the purpose** while satisfying the **needs of the audience**.

Organizing and Designing Web Pages

Organizing Web Pages

Start by listing everything you want to include on sticky notes or index cards.

Group similar topics together and arrange them into an outline with **main topics and subtopics**.

Common ways to organize webpages

- By **category**
- By **task** (e.g., “Apply Now,” “Pay Fee”)
- By **product**
- By **date/time**
- By **department**

Site Structure Options

- **Linear structure:** Pages move forward one after another, like a flowchart.
- **Hierarchical structure:** Pages arranged like an organizational chart, with main pages and subpages.

Hyperlinks

Hyperlinks (links) connect:

- Pages **within the website**
- Pages to **external websites**

Links allow users to move easily and interact quickly with the site.

Designing Web Pages

Follow these principles to create a useful and attractive webpage.

1. Header

The header is the banner at the top of a webpage.

It sets the **mood, tone, and identity** of the site.

Example:

A luxury hotel website may use elegant fonts and gold accents.

A sports car site may use bright colors, bold fonts, and a photo of a fast car.

2. Page Layout

- Use **headings and subheadings** so users can scan quickly.
- If the page is long, divide it into **shorter pages** with links.
- Avoid **horizontal scrolling**.

3. Line Length

Ideal line length: **50–70 characters per line**.

This reduces eye strain and makes scanning easier.

4. Graphics

Graphics:

- Break up text
- Add visual interest
- Support meaning
- Reflect the purpose of the website

However:

- Too many graphics slow the page down
- Large images may frustrate users

5. Multimedia

Animation, audio, and video can make pages engaging.

But:

- Too much movement distracts users
- Large media files slow loading

Use multimedia **only when necessary**.

6. Tables

Tables help organize text or graphics into neat sections.

They create a **clean and professional** look.

Rows and columns help display:

- Data
- Comparisons
- Prices
- Timetables

Tables can even be nested inside one another.

7. Borders

Borders can:

- Separate content
- Create structure
- Enhance readability

Some designers prefer **borderless layouts** for a clean, modern look.

8. Fonts

For screen reading:

- **Sans serif fonts** (Arial, Helvetica, Roboto) are better.
- Avoid ALL CAPS—hard to read.
- Avoid large blocks of bold text.

9. Colors

Color affects mood and cultural meaning.

Examples:

- In the US, red means **danger**.
- In China, red represents **good luck and wealth**.
- Blue often represents **trustworthiness**.

Use color to:

- Attract attention
- Highlight important points
- Create a pleasing design

Avoid harsh or unusual color combinations (e.g., purple on blue).

Accessibility

Accessibility ensures web content can be used by people with:

- Visual impairments
- Hearing impairments
- Mobility issues
- Learning or reading disabilities

This includes:

- Proper font size
- Alt-text for images
- Closed captions
- Keyboard navigation

Accessible websites reach **more users** and meet international guidelines.

Writing Text for the Web

Writing for the web is similar to writing any technical document, but one major difference is the **screen**. People read on devices of different sizes, so we must organize content carefully so it stays clear and easy to navigate.

Below are the important principles for writing effective web text, with examples added for better understanding.

1. Page Title

Give every page a **short, descriptive** title.

Example:

Instead of *"About Us Page of Our Company Website"* → write *"About Us"*.

Good titles help people quickly understand the page from the browser tab or history list.

2. Audience

Know who will read the content and write for them. Use simple words and avoid technical jargon unless the reader is expected to understand it.

Example:

For general users, write *"computer speed"* instead of *"processing latency"*.

3. Inverted Pyramid

Present the most important information **first**, followed by supporting details.

Example:

A travel website should begin with:

"Pokhara is a popular tourist destination known for its lakes and mountain views."

Then give additional details like things to do, timings, and costs.

4. Facts, Not Hype

Keep the content factual and useful. Avoid exaggerated marketing language.

Example:

Avoid: *"This is the world's greatest laptop ever!"*

Use: *"This laptop has an i7 processor, 16GB RAM, and a 1TB SSD."*

People want reliable information, not drama.

5. Scannable Text

Online readers scan instead of reading word-for-word. Use:

- Short paragraphs
- Short sentences
- Highlighted keywords

Example:

Long paragraph → break into 2–3 lines with bullet points.

6. Headings

Use short, clear headings that tell readers what each section is about.

Example:

Instead of *"Some Other Important Matters"* → write *"Payment Options"*.

Good headings help readers decide quickly what to read.

7. Paragraphs to Lists

Convert long paragraphs into bullet lists to reduce text and highlight important points.

Example:

Instead of writing:

“You need to carry a pen, notebook, calculator, and ID card.”

Use a list:

- Pen
- Notebook
- Calculator
- ID card

8. Keywords

Use important keywords—especially in the first 50 words—so search engines and readers can easily find the page.

Example:

If the article is about web hosting, the first paragraph should naturally contain words like *web hosting, server, domain*.

Special Web Pages

Home Page

The home page is the first page visitors see—also called the **landing page**.

Tips:

- Catch the reader’s attention and state the purpose
- Keep introduction and conclusion short
- Add short helpful links
- Include essential information

Example:

A school home page might immediately show *“Admissions Open,” “Courses,” “Contact,”* etc.

Blogs

A blog is an online journal where writers post content in reverse chronological order (latest first).

A blogger usually writes about topics they know or feel strongly about.

Before posting a blog:

- Choose topics you understand
- Post regularly
- Create a short, memorable blog name
- Provide accurate information
- Make the blog visually appealing

Example:

A tech blogger might post new tutorials every Friday.

FAQ (Frequently Asked Questions)

FAQ pages answer common questions.

Guidelines:

- Identify the most common questions users ask
- Phrase questions the way users would ask them
- Update the page regularly
- Organize questions by importance or topic
- Keep answers short and clear

Example:

Q: *“How do I reset my password?”*

A: *“Click ‘Forgot Password’ on the login page and follow the steps.”*

Wikis

A wiki allows multiple people to collaboratively write and edit pages. Some are open (Wikipedia), while others are restricted (medical wikis).

When contributing:

- Read guidelines before writing
- Keep tone polite
- Use factual information
- Provide references

Example:

When writing about “Photosynthesis,” include scientific sources, not personal opinion.

Discussion Forums

A discussion forum is a place where users ask questions or discuss topics.

Example:

On Apple’s forum, users help each other solve problems related to MacBooks or iPhones.

Guidelines:

- Read previous posts so you know the discussion style
- Give complete details when posting a question
- Respond with accurate information
- Keep replies short and focused

Information Reports

An information report is a **statement or description of events, facts, or findings** related to a specific problem, topic, or research area. It focuses on **transmitting accurate information** for a clear purpose.

A good report includes:

- a clear idea or problem
- procedure for collecting and analyzing data
- significance of findings
- conclusion and recommendation (if needed)

Example: A report on “Air Pollution in Kathmandu” describes data collection, analysis, major causes, and suggestions.

Steps in Writing a Report

1. Sensing/Realizing a Problem

Example: Noticing students' declining academic performance.

2. Literature Review

Reviewing previous studies or reports related to the problem.

3. Plan the Report

Decide structure, method, and objectives.

4. Collect Relevant Data

Surveys, interviews, observations, documents, etc.

5. Draft the Report

Prepare the first written version.

6. Edit and Proofread

Correct grammar, clarity, facts.

7. Make a Final Copy

Prepare a clean and polished version.

Organizing a Report

A well-organized report involves:

- preparing an outline
- planning time
- arranging data
- copyediting and proofreading
- compiling the final report
- preparing for presentation or viva

Short reports → Title, Introduction, Body, Conclusion

Medium/long reports → Several additional sections (summary, references, appendix, etc.)

Characteristics of a Good Report

1. Accuracy

Information must be correct, reliable, and based on clear writing.

Example: Using correct data from official records, not assumptions.*

2. Effectiveness

The report should fulfill its objective.

Example: A report on library use should clearly show why students use or don't use the library.*

3. Clarity

Writing must be simple, direct, and easy to understand.

4. Completeness

All necessary information should be included so the report stands on its own.

5. Objectivity

Writing must be free from emotions and based on facts or empirical data.

6. Appropriate Language & Structure

The format and language should match the report type.

Components of a Formal Report

A formal report is divided into **three major parts**.

1. Preliminaries

These are the **front-end materials** that help readers understand the nature and purpose of the report.

They generally include:

- **Acceptance/Certification Page**
- **Abstract/Summary** (purpose, procedure, findings, recommendations)
- **Acknowledgement**
- **Table of Contents**

Example: A research project submitted to a university usually contains all these sections.*

2. Main Body / Text of the Report

This is the central part of the report and includes three sections:

a) Introduction

Prepares readers to understand the report. Includes:

- **Background**
- **Objectives**
- **Rationale of the Study** (why the study is important)

Example: Stating why water supply quality needs investigation.*

b) Body

Contains:

- detailed information
- analysis
- interpretation of data

This section supports the conclusions and recommendations.

c) Conclusion and Recommendation

- Summarizes the main ideas and findings
- Points out major conclusions
- Suggests necessary actions

Example: Recommending installation of water filters based on findings.*

3. Supplementary

This section provides **extra information** for readers who want more detail.

In online reports, these may appear as links.

Subsections include:

a) Appendix

Contains materials related to the report but too long or unnecessary for everyone—such as:

- graphs
- figures
- raw data
- questionnaires

b) References

Lists all sources used. This avoids plagiarism and fulfills ethical/legal requirements.

c) Index

Alphabetical list of names and subjects with page numbers.

Useful in long reports for quick reference.

Example: Looking up “Air Quality Index – p. 30.”*

Getting Started on Informative Reports

Professionals in business and industry use specialized reports to convey information about their work. The most frequently used **informative reports** include:

- Summaries and abstracts
- Mechanism descriptions
- Progress and periodic reports
- News releases

These specialized reports often follow standard forms.

Summary and Abstract

A **summary** is a condensed version of a document. When writing an essay, we generate details to develop or support the thesis and topic sentences. Summaries require writers to do the opposite: keep only the **general information and the most important details**.

An **abstract** is even more condensed than a summary, often reducing documents to the thesis alone. Its length depends on the audience's needs and expectations.

How to Write a Summary or Abstract:

1. Take notes during presentations to avoid forgetting details.
2. Read the document multiple times to fully understand and highlight the main ideas.
3. Include the main point in the first sentence using your own words.
4. Decide whether the audience needs a few details or only the main ideas.
5. Keep summary information proportional to the original.

6. Write in **present tense**.
7. Do not give opinions—be objective.

Example:

Original paragraph: *“The IT department has introduced a new system to track student attendance using RFID cards. The system records entry and exit times and generates weekly reports for each class.”*

Summary: *The IT department now tracks student attendance with RFID cards, generating weekly reports.*

Mechanism Description

A **mechanism description** explains the main parts of a device or machine, their function, and overall design. These descriptions are commonly found in **catalogs, instruction manuals, and employee training**. Examples include **car parts, furniture, kitchen tools, or pencil sharpeners**.

How to Write a Mechanism Description:

1. Take notes, describing every part in detail.
2. Explain parts logically (e.g., left-to-right, top-to-bottom).
3. Divide the mechanism into parts and discuss each under a separate heading.
4. Include **size, color, location, and material** for each part.
5. Explain the purpose or function of each part.
6. Use **active voice** whenever possible.

Example:

Device: Electric kettle

- **Body:** Cylindrical stainless steel container that holds water.
- **Lid:** Hinged cover that prevents spillage.
- **Heating Element:** Located at the base, converts electricity into heat to boil water.
- **Handle:** Insulated plastic for safe handling.
- **Switch:** Turns the kettle on and off.

Types of Reports

1. Purpose-Based Reports

- **Informational Reports** – Present facts and data without analysis.
- **Analytical Reports** – Present facts along with interpretation and recommendations.
- **Policy Reports** – Provide information and suggestions regarding policies.
- **Feasibility Reports** – Evaluate practicality and viability of a proposed project.
- **Compliance Reports** – Show adherence to rules, standards, or regulations.

2. Time-Based Reports

- **Preliminary Reports** – Initial findings or observations before a full report.
- **Progress Reports** – Track ongoing progress of projects or tasks.
- **Final Reports** – Comprehensive report presented at the completion of a project.
- **Periodic Reports** – Prepared at regular intervals (weekly, monthly, quarterly, annually) to monitor performance.

3. Field- or Subject-Based Reports

- **Lab Reports** – Document experiments, observations, and results.
- **Technical Reports** – Provide detailed technical information on processes, methods, or research.
- **Business Reports** – Focus on organizational operations, performance, or finance.
- **News Reports** – Present current events or updates objectively.
- **General Reports** – Cover miscellaneous topics not included in other categories.

Periodic Reports

Reports prepared at regular intervals to inform authorities about organizational activities, progress, and performance.

Purpose:

- Track progress toward goals.
- Compare budgeted vs. actual expenditure.
- Identify risks or issues.
- Monitor ongoing activities.
- Example: Weekly, monthly, quarterly, or annual tax reports affecting national income.

Steps to Write Periodic Reports:

1. **Specify Time Period:** Clearly state the period covered by the report.
2. **Consider Audience:** Format and present content to meet the audience's needs.
3. **Organize Content:** Arrange tasks logically for clarity.
4. **Introduction:** Provide an overview highlighting key points.
5. **Body:**
 - Divide into sections by activity or type of work.
 - Use headings and subheadings.
 - Arrange content from most important to least important.
6. **Conclusion:** Highlight main findings and indicate expectations for the next report.
7. **Check Accuracy:** Verify all statistics, names, and factual details.

Q: Your manager asks you to prepare a monthly periodic report on the sales performance of your team. How would you structure it?

Answer :

Title: Monthly Sales Performance Report – October 2025

1. Time Period: October 1–31, 2025

2. Introduction:

This report summarizes the sales activities, achievements, and challenges of the sales team for October 2025. Key highlights include total sales, top-performing products, and comparison with previous months.

3. Body:

a) Sales Overview:

- Total sales: \$45,000
- Target sales: \$50,000
- Achievement: 90% of target

b) Product-wise Performance:

- Product A: \$20,000
- Product B: \$15,000
- Product C: \$10,000

c) Comparison with Previous Month:

- September sales: \$42,000
- Growth: 7% increase

d) Challenges:

- Delays in delivery due to supply chain issues.
- Reduced sales in Product C due to seasonal demand.

4. Conclusion:

Overall, the team performed well and achieved 90% of the target. Next month's focus will be on improving Product C sales and addressing delivery delays.

5. Notes on Accuracy:

All sales figures verified with finance records; team member contributions listed correctly.

Progress Reports

Progress reports provide updates on ongoing tasks or projects. They can be brief or detailed and typically include:

- Progress toward goals

- Comparison of budget vs. actual expenditure
- Risk factors or challenges
- Status of ongoing activities

Example:

Q: How would you report the progress of a school science project this month?

A:

Title: Monthly Science Project Progress Report – October 2025

Introduction:

This report summarizes the progress of the Grade 10 Science Club's experiment on plant growth during October 2025.

Body:

- **Experiment Setup:** All students planted seeds and recorded daily growth.
- **Progress:** 80% of the seeds germinated successfully.
- **Challenges:** Some plants dried due to irregular watering.

Conclusion:

The project is on track. Next month, students will measure plant height and record observations.

News Releases (Press Releases)

News releases are official reports prepared for the media to inform the public about events, achievements, or announcements.

- Goal: Share important information and maintain a positive image.
- Types:
 - Standard press release: Company or event announcements
 - Public Service Announcement (PSA): Provides information beneficial to the public

Example:

Q: How would you write a news release for a local library opening?

A:

Title: New Community Library Opens in Downtown

Details:

- **Date & Venue:** 12th November 2025, Central Park, Downtown
- **Event:** The library includes books, computers, and a reading area for children and adults.
- **Guest:** Mayor John Sharma inaugurated the library.
- **Outcome:** The library aims to improve reading habits and provide learning resources to the community.

Employment Communication

Definition:

Employment communication involves the written and verbal interactions between employers and job-seekers. Its purpose is to inform job-seekers about:

- Job vacancies
- Company culture
- Perks, benefits, and job security
- Attracting and retaining talented employees

Getting Started in Employment Communication

Key Components:

1. **Resume** – A concise summary of education, work experience, and skills.
2. **Cover Letter** – A personalized letter introducing yourself to the employer.
3. **Follow-Up Letter** – Sent after an interview to express continued interest.
4. **Registration Letter (if required)** – Forms or letters to register with the company or employment portal.

Purpose:

- Create a professional, positive impression
- Highlight your skills effectively on paper
- Encourage the employer to schedule an interview
- Provide information before filling out applications
- Maintain goodwill with the employer

Assessing Your Strengths

Use these questions to identify your strengths as a potential employee:

Education:

- What is your GPA?
- What special courses or certifications have you completed?
- What degrees do you hold, and from which institutions?

Employment:

- List all jobs you have held, including title, company, city/state, and dates.
- Describe duties and special projects. Be specific.

Accomplishments:

- List scholastic, job-related, extracurricular, or community achievements.
- Include honors or awards.

Resumes

Definition:

A resume is a short, precise document presenting your profile, work experience, education, and skills. It serves as your first introduction to an employer and aims to persuade them to call you for an interview.

- American English: Resume
- British English: CV (Curriculum Vitae) – both mean the same

Making Your Resume Stand Out

Tips:

- Keep it memorable; employers often spend only 15–45 seconds on initial screening.
- High school or fresh graduates: 1 page
- Experienced professionals: 2 pages acceptable
- Use formatting tools sparingly: **bold**, *italic*, CAPITALS, bullets
- Ensure the resume looks balanced and organized

Deciding Headings for Your Resume

Basic Headings:

1. **Identification:** Name, address (permanent and temporary), phone number(s), email
2. **Education:** Schools attended, dates, GPA, major course of study, extracurriculars
3. **Work Experience:** Job title, company name and location, duties, achievements, promotions
4. **Accomplishments:** Awards, honors, projects
5. **Skills:** Technical, computer, leadership, or other relevant skills

Optional Headings:

- Volunteer work
- Technical skills
- Leadership experience
- Hobbies/interests (if relevant)

Organizational Strategies for Resumes

1. Reverse Chronological Order

- List jobs, education, or experiences starting with the most recent and moving backward in time.
- Highlights your most recent experience first, which is often the most relevant to employers.
- Useful when your recent experience aligns closely with the job you are applying for.

Example:

- **Job:** Software Intern, XYZ Tech, Kathmandu (June–Aug 2025)
- **Job:** Teaching Assistant, ABC School, Kathmandu (Jan–May 2024)
- **Education:** BSc CSIT, Kathmandu University (Expected 2026)
- **Education:** High School, Sunrise Academy, Kathmandu (Graduated 2022)

2. Priority Order

- Arrange major sections from most important to least important, based on what the employer values.
- For experienced professionals, work experience may be more important than education, so it is listed first.
- Useful when you want to emphasize strengths rather than chronology.

Example:

- **Work Experience:** Project Manager, ABC Corp, Kathmandu (2018–2025)
- **Skills:** Leadership, Project Planning, Data Analysis
- **Education:** MBA, Tribhuvan University (2016–2018)
- **Accomplishments:** Awarded Employee of the Year 2020

Types of Resumes

There are **two main types** of traditional resumes, plus electronic formats:

1. Chronological Resume

Definition:

Organizes information in **reverse chronological order** (most recent first) for education and employment.

Key Features:

- Provides a history of employment and education backward through time
- Accounts for every year after school with no gaps
- Emphasizes dates in the resume layout
- Uses predictable headings (e.g., Education, Work Experience)
- Places education and work experience early in the resume

Example :

Work Experience: Software Intern, XYZ Tech, Kathmandu (June–Aug 2025)

- **Education:** BSc CSIT, Kathmandu University (Expected 2026)
- **Skills:** Python, Microsoft Office
- **Accomplishments:** 1st prize in inter-college coding competition

2. Functional Resume

Definition:

Organizes information around a person's **skills and abilities** rather than time.

Key Features:

- Highlights **special skills** or qualifications first
- May skip gaps in employment or school years
- Emphasizes skills, accomplishments, and job titles regardless of timing
- Uses less predictable headings tailored to the job (e.g., Technical Skills, Leadership Experience)
- Education and work experience may appear later in the resume

Example

- **Skills:** Project Management, Customer Service, Team Leadership
- **Accomplishments:** Managed team of 5 in volunteer project, raised \$2000 for charity
- **Work Experience:** Sales Associate, ABC Store, Kathmandu (2019–2021)
- **Education:** BBA, Tribhuvan University (2018)

3. Electronic Resumes

Definition:

Resumes adapted for **sending or posting online** using modern technology.

Types:

1. **E-mail Resume:** Sent as an attachment or part of an email
2. **ASCII Text Resume:** Uses simple text formatting for electronic transmission
3. **Scannable Resume:** Sent electronically or by mail and read by optical scanners
4. **Online Resume:** Posted on company/job websites or personal websites

Composing Resumes

When writing a resume, you need to focus on: **word choice, language, structure, keywords, and punctuation.**

1. Word Choice

- Use as few words as possible.
- Resumes have their **own grammar rules**:
 - **No full sentences or paragraphs** (too long to read quickly)
 - Use **fragments, lists, descriptive phrases, and verbs**

Examples:

- **Activities, Honors, Awards:** Use nouns or nouns + phrases
 - Example: Lions Club, National Science Award
- **Skills and Work Experience:** Use verb + what
 - Example: Sold merchandise, Analyzed data, Managed team

2. Specific Language

- Every piece of information should be **quantifiable and specific**.
- Avoid vague statements.

Examples:

Specific Language

Objective: To work part-time as a historical tour guide for a seventeenth-century governor's palace

Vague Language

Objective: To obtain a summer part-time position

3. Parallel Structure

- Keep headings, lists, and descriptions **consistent**.
- Example: If one skill starts with a verb, all skills in the list should start with verbs:
 - Designed marketing materials
 - Managed social media accounts
 - Trained new employees

4. Keywords for Scannable Resumes

- Scannable resumes are read by **software**, not humans.
- Use **nouns** instead of verbs to list skills, qualifications, and job titles in a **separate “Keywords” section**.
- Helps ensure your resume is **found by the computer when scanned**.

5. Punctuation

- Traditional punctuation is limited because resumes lack full sentences.
- **Guidelines:**
 - **Colons:** Introduce lists
 - **Commas:** Separate simple lists of three or more items
 - **Semicolons:** Separate complex lists
 - **Periods:** Break up large text blocks or indicate a change in information

Composing Employment Letters

Employment letters allow you to **present your skills and communication ability** in complete sentences and paragraphs, unlike resumes which are mostly fragments.

There are **three main types of employment letters**:

1. Cover Letter

Purpose:

- Introduces yourself to the employer
- Highlights your qualifications
- Requests an interview

Structure:

a) Opening (First Paragraph):

- Grab the reader's attention
- State your interest in the job
- Briefly summarize major qualifications
- Explain how you learned about the job

b) Summary of Qualifications (Middle Paragraphs):

- Justify why you are a good fit for the job
- Highlight education, work experience, and skills
- Include abilities not mentioned in your resume
- **Do not repeat your resume word for word**

c) Request for Interview (Closing Paragraph):

- Encourage the employer to contact you
- Mention the enclosed resume
- Include phone number and email
- Politely request an interview

Types of Job Applications:

1. **Solicited:** Written in response to a job advertisement
2. **Unsolicited:** Written to a company even if no position is advertised

Example:

Lazimpat-8, Kathmandu, Nepal

November 10, 2025

The Manager

Human Resource Department

ABC Solutions

New Baneshwor, Kathmandu, Nepal

Sub: Application for Software Developer

Dear Sir/Madam,

I am writing to express my interest in the Software Developer position at TechNova Solutions, which I found advertised on your company website. I recently completed my BSc CSIT from Kathmandu University and have internship experience in web development and database management.

During my internship at XYZ Tech, I developed a web application that improved workflow efficiency by 20%. I also have strong skills in Python, JavaScript, and problem-solving, which I believe will allow me to contribute effectively to your team.

I have enclosed my resume and copies of my academic certificates for your review. I would greatly appreciate the opportunity to discuss my qualifications further and can be reached at 980xxxxxxx or email@example.com at your convenience.
Thank you for your time and consideration.

Yours sincerely,

Aashish Panta

Enclosures:

1. Resume
2. Academic certificates

2. Follow-Up Letter

Purpose:

- Sent after an interview
- Express thanks and maintain interest

Key Points:

- Thank the employer for the interview
- Remind them of a positive point from the interview
- Reinforce why you are the best candidate
- Show continued interest

3. Resignation Letter

Purpose:

- Formally inform your employer about leaving the job
- Maintain professionalism and goodwill

Guidelines:

- Follow company procedure and chain of command
- Address the letter to your immediate supervisor
- Clearly state your intention to resign
- Mention your last working day
- Use polite language (please, thank you, might, probably)
- Compliment your employer or company